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VERTICAL PLANT GROWTH SYSTEM

Abstract

A plant growth system for growing one or more plants is provided. The system may be wall mountable and includes a decorative cover. The system may provide automated environmental controls and may include a sensor module for monitoring plant conditions and environmental parameters, a processor or controller for analyzing sensor data and determining optimal growth conditions, and an actuation module for automatically adjusting grow light intensity and nutrient delivery via a hydroponic module. The system may further include a user interface module with an electronic display and a mobile application for user interaction and remote control. The plant growth system may have a modular design, allowing for interchangeable components and customization of the aesthetic and/or functional properties of the system. The cover may function as an in-situ germination chamber.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/556,972, filed Feb. 23, 2024, the entirety of which is hereby incorporated by reference.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0002] The present invention relates generally to a plant-growing system. More particularly, the present invention relates to a plant-growing system that may be mounted on a wall and that includes a decorative cover.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0003] Plant-growing systems (e.g., hydroponic, aeroponic, and fogponic growing systems) are a convenient option for growing plants. For example, some plant-growing systems help to provide water, light, and fertilizer to plants.

[0004] However, existing plant-growing systems are not without deficiencies. For example, existing systems are designed based purely on utilitarian considerations and lack aesthetic or visual appeal. This results in structures that are visually unappealing and clash with typical home décor. Moreover, conventional plant—growing systems—even those designed for indoor use—are bulky and occupy considerable floor space. This presents a challenge for consumers who wish to integrate plant cultivation into their living spaces without sacrificing valuable floor space or compromising the aesthetics or visual harmony of the space. Thus, consumers seeking to incorporate greenery and plant-cultivation into their living space face a tradeoff between functionality, floor space, and visual appeal.

[0005] Additionally, some systems incorporate automation, sensors, and other electronic components, these “smart” systems often lack aesthetic appeal and seamless integration into a home environment. Further, these systems can be complex, expensive, and may not offer the modularity and user-friendly features necessary for convenient home use. Thus, a need exists for a space-efficient, aesthetically pleasing, and intelligent plant growth system that can provide automated environmental control and is tailored for indoor home environments.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0006] A plant growth system or wall hanging configured to grow one or more plants is provided. The wall hanging includes a cover that may have a cover or display such as a photograph, a painting, an electronic display (e.g., an LCD display), etc. positioned and located thereon. In addition, the cover may be coupled to an array system with one or more plant holders, which may include one or more cameras, sensors, or other electronic components in some cases. The plant holders are positioned and located adjacent to through-holes on the cover. As such, the plants in the plant holders may extend through the cover.

[0007] In addition, the wall hanging may include a grow light for providing light to the plants. In some embodiments, the grow light may be coupled to a mount. However, in other embodiments, the grow light may be moveable between a first position and a second position. When the grow light is in the first position, the grow light may be positioned and located adjacent to the cover. In contrast, when the grow light is in the second position, the grow light may be positioned and located outwardly from the cover. Thus, the grow light may direct light toward the plants when the grow light is in the second position.

[0008] In some embodiments, the plant growth system may include a sensor module configured to monitor and collect data regarding plant conditions, environmental conditions, etc., thereby providing comprehensive feedback on the growing environment. A processor may analyze the data

from the sensor module and may facilitate automatic responses to changing plant needs and/or environmental conditions. An actuation module may be in communication with the processor and may be configured to perform adjustments of one or more parameters, and a user interface module may be provided to enable a user to interface with and/or control the system. The plant growth system may further include a hydroponic module configured to direct fluid to the plants, a nutrient management module configured to retain and dispense one or more nutrients or nutrient solutions, and a grow light module configured to emit light toward the plants.

[0009] The plant growth system may be modular in design. Key components such as the frame, cover, plant holders, sensor module, control module, actuation module, hydroponic module, and grow light module are interchangeable and customizable. This modularity may allow users to adapt the system aesthetically and functionally to accommodate different environments, plant types, etc. The body of the system may include an interchangeable frame, allowing for customization of aesthetics and materials. The cover is also interchangeable and can be configured to function as an in-situ germination chamber when in a closed position.

[0010] These aspects are merely illustrative of the innumerable aspects associated with the present invention and should not be deemed as limiting in any manner. These and other aspects, features, and advantages of the present invention will become apparent from the following detailed description when taken in conjunction with the referenced drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0011] For a better understanding of the present invention, reference may be made to the following accompanying drawings.

[0012] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a wall hanging constructed according to the teachings hereof, the wall hanging in a first position.

[0013] FIG. 2 is a front elevation view of a cover of the wall hanging of FIG. 1.

[0014] FIG. 3 is a front elevation view of an array system of the wall hanging of FIG. 1.

[0015] FIG. 4 is a side elevation view of the cover and array system of FIGS. 2 and 3, respectively.

[0016] FIG. 5 is a perspective view of an array unit of the array system of FIG. 2.

[0017] FIG. 6 is a cross-section section view of the array unit of FIG. 5.

[0018] FIG. 7 is a perspective view of a plant holder of the array unit of FIGS. 5 and 6.

[0019] FIG. 8 is a perspective view of the wall hanging of FIG. 1 in a second position.

[0020] FIG. 9A is a perspective view of a second embodiment of a wall hanging constructed according to the teachings hereof, the wall hanging in a first position.

[0021] FIG. 9B is a perspective view of the wall hanging of FIG. 9A, the wall hanging in a second position.

[0022] FIG. 10A is a perspective view of a third embodiment of a wall hanging constructed according to the teachings hereof, the wall hanging in a first position.

[0023] FIG. 10B is a perspective view of the wall hanging of FIG. 10A, the wall hanging in a second position.

[0024] FIG. 11 is a perspective view of a fourth embodiment of a wall hanging constructed according to the teachings hereof.

[0025] FIG. 12 is a perspective view of a fifth embodiment of a wall hanging constructed according to the teachings hereof.

[0026] FIG. 13 is a schematic depiction of a plant growth system constructed according to the teachings hereof.

[0027] FIG. 14 is a schematic depiction of a first fluid delivery system of the plant growth system of FIG. 13.

[0028] FIG. 15 is a schematic depiction of a second fluid delivery system of the plant growth system of FIG. 14.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0029] FIG. 1 illustrates a plant growth system including a body or wall hanging 10 configured for growing one or more plants 15. The wall hanging 10 may be mounted on a vertical surface such as a wall (not illustrated) similarly to a framed piece of art. For example, the wall hanging 10 may be configured for mounting on a variety of vertical surfaces such as walls, partitions, screens, furniture, and the like. The wall hanging 10 may be mounted via any suitable mechanism or technique including brackets (e.g., L-shaped, Z-shaped, etc.), adhesives, hooks, support legs, and/or other mounting mechanisms or components. In some embodiments, the wall hanging 10 may be freestanding. For example, the wall hanging 10 may lean against a vertical surface without being directly coupled to it. The modularity of the wall hanging 10 allows for interchangeable frames and mounting mechanisms to suit various aesthetic and installation preferences.

[0030] The wall hanging 10 may include a cover 20 that the plants 15 extend at least partially through. The cover 20 may be generally planar and sized to correspond to the dimensions of the body of the wall hanging 10. As described in further detail below, the cover 20 may be designed to provide an aesthetically pleasing visible surface for the wall hanging 10 (e.g., transforming the wall hanging 10 into a decorative element) and/or to act as a functional interface, potentially influencing the environment for the plants 15. The cover 20 may be modular and interchangeable, allowing users to customize the visual appearance and/or the functional properties of the wall hanging 10.

[0031] As illustrated in FIG. 2, in some embodiments, the cover 20 may include a painting or a photograph. However, in other embodiments, the cover 20 may be a material such as canvas, plastic, wood, metal, fabric, other materials, or combinations thereof, and the cover 20 may be imparted with a solid color, gradient, pattern, visual effect or texture, or other design. In some cases, the cover 20 may include or may be formed from “living materials” such as vine, moss, and the like. In further embodiments, the cover 20 may be provided in the form of an electronic display (e.g., an LCD screen, interactive touch screen, etc.) configured to display a desired graphic or series of graphics. For example, the cover 20 may be provided in the form of a user interface module (e.g., the user interface module 740 of FIG. 13) configured to receive user input or adjustments, display plant health data, environmental data, system settings, trend analysis, anomaly detection alerts, or perform other functions. In this way, the cover 20 may enhance the smart functionality of the system by facilitating real-time feedback and control. In other embodiments, the cover 20 may be provided in other forms.

[0032] In addition, the cover 20 may include through-holes 25 for the plants 15 to extend through. For example, the cover 20 may include a plurality of through-holes 25, and the through-holes 25 may be selectively positioned on the cover 20 such that the plants 15 may at least partially extend therethrough and may be visible from a front of the wall hanging 10. In some embodiments, the through-holes 25 may be formed by two intersecting slits (e.g., forming an X-shape), thereby enabling the through-hole 25 to accommodate plant stems of various diameters and enabling some flexibility in the position of the plant 15 within the through-hole 25. However, in other embodiments, the through-holes 25 may be provided in any suitable form (e.g., openings having a circular, ovoid, rectangular, irregular, or other shape).

[0033] In the example of FIG. 2, the cover 20 may include twenty-four through-holes 25 arranged in a grid-like pattern having four rows and six columns. However, in other embodiments, there may be more or fewer through-holes 25 arranged in any suitable configuration. For example, in some embodiments, the through-holes 25 may be arranged in a circular pattern or a spiral pattern. In some embodiments, the through-holes 25 may be substantially evenly distributed on the cover 20, whereas in other embodiments, the through-holes 25 may be concentrated in or limited to one or more finite regions of the cover 20. For example, the through-holes 25 may be grouped and positioned to coincide with a specific design element or image on the cover 20, such as a region of

the cover **20** depicting a plant or flower.

[0034] Beyond its aesthetic function, the cover **20** may also serve as an environmental interface regulating one or more environmental conditions affecting the plants **15**. In some embodiments, the cover **20** may be configured to provide an integrated or in-situ germination system within the wall hanging **10**. For example, the cover **20** may be configured to be movable between a closed position and an open position. The cover **20**, when in the closed position, may create a localized environment within the wall hanging **10** that is at least partially enclosed and is conducive to seed germination. For example, in the closed position, the cover **20** may act as a natural barrier to light and/or air, for example, in order to reduce light exposure and trap humidity within the wall hanging **10** to create a “plant growth area.” The function of the cover **20** as an in-situ germination chamber is enhanced by the interchangeable nature of the cover **20**, which may enable users to select covers with specific light and/or air permeability characteristics optimized for germination.

[0035] In some embodiments, the cover **20** may be formed from a material (e.g., paper, mesh, other materials, combinations thereof, etc.) selected based on desired characteristics such as air permeability and light permeability. Further, the cover **20** may include materials and/or coatings configured to offer some degree of light diffusion or reflection. In other embodiments, the cover **20** may be provided in any suitable form and may be configured to regulate the temperature, humidity, and/or other conditions to which the plants **15** are exposed.

[0036] In some embodiments, the in-situ germination function of the wall hanging **10** may incorporate a gradual acclimation process. For example, after a pre-determined “germination period” (e.g., a pre-determined time interval), the cover **20** may be progressively opened. In other words, the cover **20** may move at least partially from the closed position to the open position when the germination period expires. The progressive opening of the cover **20** may take place over a period of time such that the plants **15** can gradually acclimate to ambient conditions (e.g., ambient air and light conditions). In this way, progressively opening the cover **20** may reduce or prevent any shock experienced by the nascent plants **15** and facilitate necessary developmental processes of the plants **15** such as phototropism and gravitropism.

[0037] As mentioned above, the cover **20** may be configured to be modular and/or interchangeable. For example, the cover **20** may be detachably coupled to the wall hanging **10** via various coupling mechanisms (e.g., clips, magnets, interlocking panels, sliding mechanisms, etc.) such that the cover **20** can be conveniently removed and replaced. This enables users to customize the visual appearance of the wall hanging **10** and to alter the functional properties of the wall hanging **10** by installing the desired cover **20**.

[0038] FIG. 3 illustrates an array system **30** configured for retaining one or more plant holders **35** on the wall hanging **10**. The plant holders **35** may be modular and/or interchangeable such that a user can conveniently remove and/or replace the plant holders **35** as desired, allowing for customization based on plant size and type. The array system **30** may be positioned behind the cover **20**, as can be seen in FIG. 4, and may be configured to support the plant holders **35** and/or to facilitate the flow of fluid toward the plant holders **35**. The array system **30** includes a front surface **40** that is selectively couplable with the cover **20** (see, e.g., FIG. 2). For example, the front surface **40** may be configured to be detachably coupled to the cover **20** and/or other components of the wall hanging **10**. However, in other embodiments, the array system **30** may be integrally formed with the cover **20**.

[0039] As illustrated in FIG. 4, the array system **30** may include one or more array units **45** that are each configured to receive one of the plant holders **35**. The array units **45** may protrude outwardly from a rear surface **50** of the array system **30**, and the array units **45** may be integrally formed with the array system **30** or may be coupled thereto. Further, the array units **45** may be arranged on the array system **30** such that the plant holders **35** are positioned and located adjacent to the through-holes **25** of the cover **20** (see, e.g., FIG. 2). However, other configurations for the array units **45** are also foreseeable. In some embodiments, the array units **45** may be provided as modular units

configured to be detachably coupled to the array system **30**. For example, the array units **45** may be interchangeable and may be arranged in a variety of different configurations depending on the circumstances. However, in other embodiments, the array units **45** may be formed integrally with the array system **30**.

[0040] The wall hanging **10** may be configured to provide fluid **55** (e.g., water, a nutrient solution, combinations thereof, etc.) to each of the plant holders **35**, for example, via a hydroponic module as described below with reference to FIG. **13**, to nourish the plants **15**. For example, a reservoir **56** may be provided to retain a supply of the fluid **55**. In some embodiments, the reservoir **56** may be positioned and located proximate to a lower region **60** of the wall hanging **10**. In these instances, the reservoir **56** may be coupled to and/or in communication with a pump **57** configured to direct fluid from the lower region **60** to an upper region **65** of the wall hanging **10**, for example, via one or more pipes or conduits (not illustrated). Once the fluid **55** has been transported from the reservoir **56** to the upper region **65** of the wall hanging **10** (e.g., by the pump **57**), the fluid **55** may flow from the upper region **65** toward the lower region **60** via gravity (e.g., in a gravity-fed cascading system). In other instances, the reservoir **56** may be positioned and located proximate to the upper region **65**, and the pump **57** may be omitted. As the fluid **55** flows downwardly, each of the array units **45** may receive the fluid **55** and guide the fluid **55** toward the various plant holders **35**. Thus, the array units **45** preferably help with providing the fluid **55** to the plants **15**. However, in further embodiments, the fluid **55** may be sprayed upwardly onto the plants **15** (e.g., as a mist provided by a misting system), may be provided by a drip irrigation system or a hydroponic circulation system, or may be provided via any other suitable fluid delivery system. The fluid delivery system may be part of a hydroponic module (e.g., the hydroponic module **610** of FIG. **13**), which may be modular such that the reservoir **56** and/or other components of the fluid delivery system are interchangeable.

[0041] In some embodiments, the wall hanging **10** may further include one or more sensors **58** configured to monitor and facilitate operation of the wall hanging **10** to maintain suitable conditions for the plants **15**. The sensors **58** may be incorporated into a sensor module (e.g., the sensor module **730** of FIG. **13**), which may be a modular and/or interchangeable component configured to generate plant condition data, environmental data, and/or other data affecting the growing environment of the plants **15**. For example, the sensors **58** may include soil moisture sensors, water level sensors, temperature sensors, humidity sensors, pressure sensors, nutrient sensors (e.g., pH sensors, EC sensors, ISE sensors), and the like. Additionally, in some instances, one or more sensors **58** may be provided in the form of visual sensors such as cameras, depth sensors, and the like. The sensors **58** may be selectively positioned throughout the system (e.g., positioned on or coupled to the wall hanging **10**), including being positioned on or within the plant holders **35**, on or within the reservoir **56**, on or within other components of the system, and/or in the ambient environment surrounding the wall hanging **10**. The sensors **58** may be in communication with a controller or processor (e.g., the processor **750** of FIG. **13**) via any suitable wired or wireless communication protocol.

[0042] In some embodiments, one or more of the plant holders **35** may include a soil moisture sensor for detecting the level of moisture in the plant holder **35**. When one of the soil moisture sensors detects that the level of moisture is below a threshold value, the pump may be powered on such that the fluid **55** is provided to the plants **15**. However, when one of the soil moisture sensors detects that the level of moisture is above a threshold value, the pump may be powered off to prevent overwatering the plants. In addition, the wall hanging **10** may include a water level sensor positioned and located in the reservoir **56**. If the water level sensor detects that the volume of fluid **55** in the reservoir **56** is below a threshold value, the wall hanging **10** may send a notification to the user (e.g., via a mobile device). Further, the wall hanging **10** may include temperature sensors, humidity sensors, and/or pressure sensors, cameras, depth sensors, and/or other sensors configured to collect data regarding the wall hanging **10**, the plants **15**, the reservoir **56**, the plant holders **35**,

and/or other components. In other words, the sensors **58** may be provided in any suitable form. In some embodiments, multiple sensors **58** may be provided with one or more of the plant holders **35**, the plant holders **35** may each include multiple sensors **58**, and additional sensors **58** may be positioned elsewhere on the wall hanging **10**. The data from any of the one or more sensors **58** may be used (e.g., by the processor **750** or other processor or controller) to analyze, monitor, regulate, and/or adjust the growing conditions of the plants **15**.

[0043] Turning to FIG. **5**, the array units **45** may include features configured to facilitate the delivery of fluid to the associated plant holder **35** and/or plant **15**. For example, each of the array units **45** may include a channel **70** for guiding the fluid **55** to the plant holders **35**. The channels **70** may be provided in the form of grooves, depressions, conduits, and the like, and may be formed on an upper side **75** of each array unit **45**. Thus, the channels **70** may receive the fluid **55** as the fluid **55** flows downwardly through the wall hanging **10**. Then, once the fluid **55** is received by one of the channels **70**, the channel **70** may convey the fluid **55** to a spout **80**, and the spout **80** may discharge the fluid **55** toward the plant holder **35**. Thus, the array units **45** may be configured to guide the fluid **55** to the plant holders **35**.

[0044] FIG. **5** illustrates a lateral side **82** and a rear side **83** of one of the plant holders **35**. The lateral side **82** and the rear side **83** may each include a permeable portion **85** and a drip feature **90**. However, it is to be understood that the other sides of the plant holder **35**, which are not illustrated, may also include a permeable portion **85** and a drip feature **90**.

[0045] The permeable portion **85** may be configured to allow fluid **55** to pass into and out of the plant holder **35**, thereby facilitating hydration of the plant **15** and drainage of excess fluid. For example, the permeable portion **85** may be formed by perforations, mesh, porous material, and/or other suitable materials or structures that allow fluid passage while retaining the contents of the plant holder **35**. The plant holder **35** may include permeable portions **85** positioned on multiple (e.g., all) sides of the body **120**, and in some instances, the permeable portion **85** may extend across substantially all of the exterior surface of the body **120**.

[0046] The drip feature **90** may be configured to manage excess fluid **55** that may adhere to an exterior of the plant holder **35** or the array unit **45**. For example, when the plant holder **35** is received by the array unit **45**, the permeable portion **85** on the rear side **83** may be positioned and located to receive the fluid **55** from the spout **80**. However, as fluid **55** exits the spout **80**, some of the fluid **55** may adhere to plant holder **35** and/or the lower side **95** of the array unit **45**. The adhered fluid **55** can then flow around the plant holder **35**. The drip feature **90** is positioned to intercept this adhered fluid **55** as it flows around the plant holder **35**. For example, the drip feature **90** may intercept the adhered fluid **55** and may direct the fluid **55** downwardly to prevent fluid **55** from flowing toward the cover **20** (see, e.g., FIG. **4**).

[0047] Referring to FIG. **6**, a hydroponic grow media **100** may be positioned within the plant holder **35** and configured to support the roots of the plant **15** and retain moisture and/or nutrients. For example, the hydroponic grow media **100** may be provided in the form of a variety of material such as a sponge, peat pellets, mineral wool, gravel, soil, and the like. The fluid **55** may be received by a hydroponic grow media **100** after the fluid **55** passes through one of the permeable portions **85**. The hydroponic grow media **100** may retain the fluid **55** so that the plant **15** can absorb the fluid **55** therefrom. However, if the hydroponic grow media **100** is saturated, the excess fluid **55** may exit the plant holder **35** proximate to a lower end **105** (e.g., through one of the permeable portions **85**). After exiting the plant holder **35**, the excess fluid **55** may continue to flow downwardly to another array unit **45**.

[0048] As the fluid **55** exits the plant holder **35**, some of the fluid **55** may flow toward the cover **20** (see, e.g., FIG. **4**). However, each of the array units **45** may include a lip **110** that curves downwardly. As such, the lip **110** may receive the fluid **55** flowing toward the cover **20**, and the lip **110** may direct the fluid **55** downwardly to another array unit **45**. Thus, the lip **110** may also help to prevent fluid **55** from reaching the cover **20**.

[0049] In some embodiments, the wall hanging **10** may be a gravity-driven cascading fluid delivery system. As mentioned above, a reservoir **56** proximate to the lower region **60** may act as a source of fluid **55** (e.g., water, nutrient solutions, combinations thereof, etc.). The fluid **55** may be moved from the reservoir to the upper region **65** via a pump or other mechanism. Once the fluid **55** is elevated to the upper region **65**, the wall hanging **10** may leverage gravity for downward distribution of the fluid **55** to the plants **15**. As the fluid **55** flows from the upper region **65** to the lower region **60**, the fluid **55** interacts with (e.g., encounters, flows around) the array units **45**. As described above, the array units **45** may guide the fluid **55** toward the various plant holders **35** via the channels **70**, spouts **80**, permeable portions **85**, and/or other parts. In this way, the wall hanging **10** may provide simple, energy-efficient delivery of fluid **55** to the plants **15**.

[0050] In other embodiments, other fluid delivery methods such as drip irrigation, misting systems, timed-release systems, hydroponic circulation systems, and/or suitable methods or mechanisms may be employed to deliver the fluid **55** to the plants **15**. For example, the fluid **55** may be sprayed upwardly onto the plants **15** in the form of a mist. In some embodiments, the delivery of fluid **55** to the plants **15** may be automated to some degree—for example, the sensors **58** may monitor internal and/or external environmental conditions (e.g., moisture, temperature, light levels, nutrient levels, etc.) and regulate the delivery of fluid **55** as needed. As one non-limiting example, a control module **735** and an actuation module **740** may utilize data received from a sensor module **730** to monitor plant conditions and/or environmental conditions, as depicted in FIG. **13** and described in further detail below. In such cases, the sensors **58** may be in communication with an external device or application (e.g., a mobile application interface) that enables a user to remotely monitor and control the growth of the plants **15**.

[0051] In some embodiments, the delivery system may be configured to provide more comprehensive environmental control. For example, the wall hanging **10** may be configured to provide the plants **15** with nutrients, fertilizers, pesticides, and/or other substances in addition to the fluid **55**. A filtration mechanism (not illustrated) may also be provided to create a closed-loop system that recirculates and filters fluids to conserve resources and reduce waste. For example, the filtration mechanism may be configured to maintain water quality and prevent the buildup of harmful substances in the fluid **55** by removing debris, pathogens, mineral precipitates, and/or other substances from the circulating fluid **55**.

[0052] FIG. **6** further illustrates the manner in which the plant holders **35** are received by the array units **45**. In particular, each of the array units **45** may include an aperture **115** that is sized and shaped to receive a body **120** of the plant holders **35**. For example, the aperture **115** may be shaped and sized to complement the body **120** to provide a snug and stable fit. In addition, in some instances, each of the plant holders **35** may include a flange **125** that is configured to engage with the lip **110**. Thus, the flanges **125** may help to retain the plant holders **35** in the apertures **115**.

[0053] FIG. **7** illustrates the plant holder **35** in greater detail. As a non-limiting example, in some embodiments, the body **120** of the plant holder **35** may be shaped as a rectangular prism that is substantially symmetrical. Thus, the plant holder **35** may be placed in one of the array units **45** of the array system **30** (see, e.g., FIG. **3**) in at least four different configurations. However, in other embodiments, the plant holder **35** may be provided with any desirable shape and/or size. Moreover, in some embodiments, the plant holders **35** are each provided in substantially the same form; however, one or more of the plant holders **35** may differ structurally from one or more other plant holders **35**. The plant holders **35** may be modular and/or interchangeable such that a user may select from a variety of plant holders **35** optimized for different plant sizes, root systems, and/or other parameters.

[0054] The flange **125** may wrap around or circumscribe an upper portion of the body **120** and extend outwardly therefrom. The flange **125** may be configured to engage or interact with the lip **110** of the associated array unit **45** (see, e.g., FIG. **6**). For example, the flange **125** and the lip **110** may be configured to engage each other in a snap fit, friction fit, or via any other suitable

mechanism such that the plant holder **35** is retained within the aperture **115** of the array unit **45**. [0055] Turning to FIG. **8**, the wall hanging **10** may include a grow light **130** for providing light to the plants **15**. The grow light **130** may be provided as a modular and/or interchangeable part. In some embodiments, the grow light **130** may be incorporated into a grow light module (e.g., the grow light module **615** of FIG. **13**). For example, the grow light **130** may be designed to provide supplemental artificial light to the plants **15**, particularly in indoor environments where natural light may be insufficient. The grow light **130** may include one or more LEDs (not illustrated) that receive power from a power cable **135**. The grow light **130** may be selectively moveable between a first position (see, e.g., FIG. **1**) and a second position (see, e.g., FIG. **8**). In some embodiments, an actuator (e.g., part of the actuator module **735** of FIG. **13**) may be configured to control movement of the grow light **130** between the first position and the second position.

[0056] When the grow light **130** is in the first position, a first arm **140** and a second arm **145** may be positioned and located adjacent to the cover **20**. As such, the arms **140**, **145** may be oriented substantially parallel to the cover **20** when the grow light **130** is in the first position. In other words, the arms **140**, **145** may be substantially coplanar with the cover **20** when the grow light **130** is in the first position. In contrast, when the grow light **130** is in the second position, the first arm **140** and the second arm **145** may be rotated outwardly from the cover **20** such that the LEDs are directed at the cover **20**. To transition the grow light **130** from the first position to the second position, a user may manually move the grow light **130**.

[0057] However, in other embodiments, movement of the grow light **130** may be controlled by an actuator (e.g., the actuation module **735** of FIG. **13**) such as a motor (not illustrated) or a hydraulic cylinder (not illustrated). The actuator may be configured to move the grow light **130** in response to control signals (e.g., signals received from the control module **730** of FIG. **13**). These control signals may be generated based on a schedule, user input via a switch, a web application, and/or a mobile application, or the control signals may be generated automatically in response to sensor data. The grow light **130** may be positioned adjacent to the cover **20** when the grow light **130** is in the first position, and the grow light **130** may be positioned at a distance of at least about **15** centimeters from the cover **20** when the grow light **130** is in the second position. Furthermore, the LEDs may automatically emit light when the grow light **130** is placed in the second position. However, in other embodiments, the LEDs may be powered on and off in response to a schedule, a switch, a web application, and/or a mobile application.

[0058] The wall hanging **10** may be provided in the form of a modular system. For example, the cover **20**, array system **30**, plant holders **35**, grow light **130**, and/or other components of the wall hanging **10** (including the plant module **605**, hydroponic module **610**, grow light module **615**, sensor module **730**, control module **735**, actuation module **740**, and/or other components of the plant growth system **600** depicted in FIG. **13**) may be designed to be coupled together or assembled such that one or more of the components of the wall hanging **10** are interchangeable and customizable. In this way, the wall hanging **10** may enable a user to customize the system's appearance and/or functionality. The modularity of the wall hanging **10** may extend to additional components of the system not specifically described herein as well as further embodiments of the present invention, as discussed in further detail below.

[0059] FIG. **9A** illustrates an alternative embodiment of a wall hanging **200**. Similar to the wall hanging **10**, the wall hanging **200** includes a cover **205** that one or more plants **15** extend through. Further, the wall hanging **200** includes a power cable **210** for providing power to the wall hanging **200**. However, in contrast to the wall hanging **10**, the wall hanging **200** includes a fill port **215** and a drain port **220**. The fill port **215** is configured for selectively adding the fluid **55** (see, e.g., FIG. **4**) to the wall hanging **200**, and the drain port **220** is configured for selectively removing the fluid **55** from the wall hanging **200**. The fill port **215** may be positioned and located on the cover **205**, and the drain port **220** may be positioned and located proximate to a lower region **225** of the wall hanging **200**. However, in other embodiments, the fill port **215** and the drain port **220** may be

positioned and located elsewhere on the wall hanging **200** (e.g., on a rear surface or a side surface). [0060] Referring to FIGS. **9A** and **9B**, the wall hanging **200** may include a grow light **230** that is moveable between a first position (as illustrated in FIG. **9A**) and a second position (as illustrated in FIG. **9B**). When the grow light **230** is in the first position, the grow light **230** may be positioned and located adjacent to the cover **205**. In contrast, when the grow light **230** is in the second position, the grow light **230** may be positioned and located at a distance from the cover **205** such that one or more LEDs (not illustrated) are directed toward the cover **205**. To transition the grow light **230** from the first position to the second position, the grow light **230** may be moved outwardly from the wall hanging **200** (e.g., manually or via an actuator). As the grow light **230** moves outwardly, a first linkage arm **235**, a second linkage arm **240**, a third linkage arm **245**, and a fourth linkage arm **250** (illustrated in FIG. **9B**) may rotate outwardly to guide the grow light **230**. In particular, the first linkage arm **235** and the second linkage arm **240** may be rotatably coupled together at a first joint **255**, and the third linkage arm **245** and the fourth linkage arm **250** may be rotatably coupled together at a second joint **260**. Thus, the linkage arms **235**, **240**, **245**, **250** may move similar to a scissor mechanism that extends outwardly as the grow light **230** transitions from the first position to the second position.

[0061] FIG. **10A** illustrates another alternative embodiment of a wall hanging **300**. Similar to the wall hangings **10**, **200**, the wall hanging **300** includes a cover **305** that one or more plants **15** extend through. Further, the wall hanging **300** includes a power cable **310** configured for providing power to the wall hanging **300**.

[0062] Referring to FIGS. **10A** and **10B**, the wall hanging **300** may include a grow light **315** that is rotatably coupled to the wall hanging **300** proximate to a lower region **320**. When the grow light **315** is in a first position (as illustrated in FIG. **10A**), the grow light **315** may be positioned and located adjacent to the cover **305**. As such, the grow light **315** may be oriented substantially parallel to the cover **305** when the grow light **315** is in the first position. In contrast, when the grow light **315** is in the second position (as illustrated in FIG. **10B**), an upper region **325** of the grow light **315** may be rotated outwardly from the cover **305**. As a result, one or more LEDs (not illustrated) may be directed toward the cover **305** when the grow light **315** is in the second position.

[0063] FIG. **11** illustrates another alternative embodiment of a wall hanging **400**. Like the wall hangings **10**, **200**, **300**, the wall hanging **400** includes a cover **405** that one or more plants **15** extend through. However, in contrast to the wall hangings **10**, **200**, **300**, the wall hanging **400** includes a mount **410** coupled to a grow light **415**. The mount **410** may protrude outwardly from a frame **420** of the wall hanging **400**, and the mount **410** may be curved so that grow light **415** is directed toward the cover **405**. Further, the mount **410** may have a hollow interior for wires and cables to extend through. Thus, the mount **410** may help to conceal the cables and wires for the grow light **415**.

[0064] FIG. **12** illustrates another alternative embodiment of a wall hanging **500**. Like the wall hanging **400**, the wall hanging **500** includes a cover **505**, a mount **510**, and a grow light **515**. However, in contrast to the wall hanging **400**, the wall hanging **500** includes a frame **520** that has rounded edges. As such, the wall hanging **500** has a different visual appearance than the wall hanging **400**, and a consumer may select the wall hanging **10**, **200**, **300**, **400**, **500** that suits their preferences.

[0065] In some embodiments, the frame (e.g., frame **420**, **520**) of the wall hanging (e.g., wall hanging **10**, **200**, **300**, **400**, **500**) may be modular and/or interchangeable such that a user can conveniently detach and/or replace the frame as desired. In this way, the wall hanging **10**, **200**, **300**, **400**, **500** may enable a user to select from a range of frame styles, materials, finishes, etc., depending on a desired aesthetic.

[0066] Turning to FIG. **13**, an exemplary configuration for a plant growth system **600** is depicted schematically and represented as several interconnected modules, with each module including one or more distinct components. The plant growth system **600** may include a plant module **605**

including a physical apparatus supporting one or more plants **15**, a hydroponic module **610** configured to direct fluid **55** to the plant module **605** to nourish and/or hydrate the plants **15**, and a grow light module **615** configured to emit light toward the plants **15**. Additionally, the plant growth system **600** may include (among other components) a sensor module **730**, an actuation module **735**, and a user interface module **740**, all of which may be modular and/or interchangeable components. [0067] The plant module **605** may be substantially similar, for example, to the wall hanging **10** and may include a frame, mounting mechanism, and/or other parts. The plant module **605** may include one or more components and/or may be configured to perform one or more functions as described above with reference to the wall hanging **10**, **200**, **300**, **400**, **500**.

[0068] As shown in FIG. **13**, in some embodiments, the plant module **605** may include a body **620**, for example, provided in the form of a frame or a wall mounting device. The body **620** may support or be coupled to a decorative and/or functional cover **625** and one or more plant holders **630**. The cover **625** may be substantially similar to the cover **20** described above. The plant holders **630** may be substantially similar to the plant holders **35** described above and may be configured to receive a grow media **635** and one or more plants **640** (e.g., the plants **640** may be substantially similar to the plants **15**). Additionally, in some embodiments, the plant module **605** may include a fill port **645** and/or a drain port **650**. For example, the fill port **645** may enable a user to add fluid (e.g., the fluid **55**) to the plant module **605**, and the drain port **650** may enable a user to remove fluid from the plant module **605**, as needed.

[0069] The grow light module **615** may include a grow light unit **655** and a grow light controller **660** configured to control the operation of the grow light unit **655**. The grow light unit **655** may be substantially similar to the grow light **130**, **230**, **315**, **415**, **515** discussed above, or the grow light unit **655** may be provided in the form of any other suitable light source. In some embodiments, the grow light unit **655** and/or the grow light module **615** may be physically coupled to or formed integrally with the plant module **605**. In other embodiments, the grow light module **615** may be provided separately from the plant module **605**.

[0070] The plant growth system **600** may further include a power module **665** configured to provide power from an external power source **670** to the grow light module **615**. The power module **665** may include a governor **675** configured to regulate the power supplied to the grow light module **615**. For example, the governor **675** may employ various mechanisms or techniques (e.g., LED drivers, pulse width modulation or PWM, zoning, etc.) to regulate or manipulate the power supplied to the grow light module **615** such that the light provided by the grow light unit **655** may be customizable. Thus, the power module **665** may be in communication with and may supply power to the grow light module **615** and/or other components of the plant growth system **600**. The grow light unit **655** may be arranged to direct light toward the plants **640**.

[0071] The hydroponic module **610** may be configured to supply one or more fluids (e.g., fluid **55**) such as water, a nutrient solution, other substances, and combinations thereof to the plant module **605**, thereby supplying the plants **640** with hydration and/or nutrients. The hydroponic module **610** may include a reservoir **680** (e.g., substantially similar to the reservoir **56** described above) configured to retain a supply of fluid. A fluid delivery system **685** of the hydroponic module **610** may include a means for directing fluid from the reservoir **680** to the plants **640**. For example, the fluid delivery system **685** may employ gravity, drip irrigation, misting, timed-release, hydroponic circulation, and/or other methods or mechanisms to direct fluid from the reservoir **680** to the plants **640**. In some embodiments, a pump **690** in communication with the reservoir **680** may be provided to facilitate movement of fluid from the reservoir **680** (e.g., to counteract the force of gravity).

[0072] In some embodiments, a nutrient management module **695** may be in communication with the hydroponic module **610** (e.g., with the reservoir **680**) and may be configured to supply the reservoir **680** with a desired mixture of fluids. For example, the nutrient management module **695** may include one or more containers **700** retaining one or more substances (e.g., nutrients known to facilitate plant growth), a mixing system **705**, and one or more mixing valves **710**. The mixing

system **705** may be configured to produce a mixture comprising one or more of the substances contained in the containers **700** and, in some instances, water. The mixing valves **710** may be configured to enable precise control of the composition of the mixture and/or to enable precise control of the amount of the mixture that is directed to the reservoir **680**. In some embodiments, the mixing system **705** and/or mixing valves **710** may be provided in the form of electronic components capable of being controlled or operated via manual controls (e.g., buttons, switches, etc.) and/or via a remote device (e.g., tablet, smartphone, etc.). In other embodiments, the nutrient management module **695** may be omitted.

[0073] In some embodiments, fluid may move directly from the nutrient management module **695** to the hydroponic module **610**, where the fluid may be received within the reservoir **680**. However, in other embodiments, an environmental control module **715** may be positioned to intercept and/or treat the fluid on its way to the hydroponic module **610**. For example, the environmental control module **715** may include an aerator **720** configured to oxygenate the fluid passing through the environmental control module **715** and/or one or more fan units **725** configured to facilitate cooling, transpiration, and/or other desired processes or effects.

[0074] In some embodiments, the plant growth system **600** may incorporate one or more computerized or electronic components configured to gather and/or analyze data, automate or partially automate one or more functions of the plant growth system **600**, enable a user to interface with and control the plant growth system **600** (or one or more components thereof), or perform other functions. For example, the user interface module **740** may be provided as a modular component of the plant growth system **600**. The user interface module **740** may include an electronic display provided on the cover **20** (see FIG. **1**). The electronic display may be configured to display plant health data, environmental data, trend analysis of plant growth data, and anomaly detection alerts for plant health issues. The user interface module **740** may be configured to receive user input for system adjustments via a touch screen interface on the electronic display, buttons, dials, voice commands, and/or via a mobile application interface for remote monitoring and control. The mobile application interface may enable remote monitoring and adjustment of system parameters, viewing of sensor data, and receiving alerts.

[0075] The sensor module **730** may include the sensors **58** discussed above, as well as additional and/or alternative components. An exemplary configuration of the sensor module **730** is depicted in FIG. **13**, but it should be understood that the sensor module **730** may be provided in a variety of forms and may be configured to perform a variety of functions. In some embodiments, the sensor module **730** may include a sensor array **745** and a processor **750** in communication with the sensor array **745**. The sensor array **745** may include one or more of each of the following: plant sensors **755**, nutrient sensors **760**, environmental sensors **765**, system sensors **770**, and/or specialized sensors **775**. The sensor array **745** may further include a data acquisition node **780** in communication with the aforementioned sensors and configured to receive, record, transmit, and/or analyze data collected therefrom.

[0076] The plant sensors **755** may be configured to monitor the status, health, growth, etc. of the plants **640** and/or other components of the plant module **605**. The plant sensors **755** may be positioned on the plant module **605** or other components of the plant growth system **600**, as desired. For example, the plant sensors **755** may be provided in the form of a camera, vision system, and/or other optical sensor configured to detect anomalies or visually apparent diseases and/or to monitor plant height, leaf area, stem diameter, overall biomass, growth rate over time, flower count, flower growth rate, and/or other characteristics. For example, the plant sensors **755** can include spectrometers, hyperspectral imaging sensors, and the like. In some embodiments, the processor **750** (or other component of the sensor module **730**) may be provided with image processing software configured to receive and interpret data from the plant sensors **755**. The plant sensors **755** may also be provided in the form of a depth sensor (e.g., time of flight sensors, structured light sensors, and the like) configured to perform three-dimensional mapping of the

plants **640**. Additionally, in some embodiments, the plant sensors **755** may be provided in the form of a weight sensor or load cell configured to measure changes in plant weight, a strain gauge configured to measure stem elongation and/or leaf expansion, a proximity sensor (e.g., infrared, ultrasonic, etc.) configured to detect plant presence or proximity to a light source, and/or other suitable sensors or data collection devices.

[0077] In some instances, the plant sensors **755** may further include sensors configured to observe or monitor the physiology or biological state of the plants **640**. For example, the plant sensors **755** can include leaf temperature sensors (e.g. infrared thermometers, contact thermocouples, etc.) configured to monitor plant stress and transpiration rates, chlorophyll fluorescence sensors configured to assess photosynthetic efficiency and overall health, sap flow sensors configured to measure the rate of water and nutrient uptake by a given plant **640**, stem diameter variation sensors (e.g., dendrometers) configured to monitor plant water status and real-time growth, leaf wetness sensors configured to detect condensation or excess moisture, and the like.

[0078] The plant sensors **755** may be positioned proximate to the plants **640**. For example, the plant sensors **755** may be positioned within the plant holders **630** (e.g., similar to the position of the sensors **58** with respect to the plant holders **35**, as shown in FIG. **4**). Alternatively, the plant sensors **755** may be positioned in any suitable location and may be positioned on or coupled to any suitable component of the plant module **605**. For example, plant sensors **755** provided in the form of an optical sensor such as a camera may be retained at a distance from the plants **640**.

[0079] The nutrient sensors **760** may be configured to monitor the status, physical characteristics, chemical attributes, etc. of the hydroponic module **610**, the nutrient management module **695**, and/or components thereof (e.g., a supply of fluid or other substance retained within the reservoir **680**, the containers **700**, and/or other components of the plant growth system **600**). The nutrient sensors **760** may be positioned on the hydroponic module **610**, the nutrient management module **695**, and/or other components of the plant growth system **600**, as desired. In some embodiments, the nutrient sensors **760** may include nutrient

[0080] concentration sensors and/or electrical conductivity (EC) sensors configured to measure an amount of dissolved salts within a nutrient solution and provide an indication regarding the nutrient solution's overall strength. The nutrient sensors **760** may also include pH sensors, dissolved oxygen (DO) sensors, turbidity sensors, suspended solids sensors, oxidation-reduction potential (ORP/Redox) sensors, specific ion sensors (ISEs), water hardness sensors, calorimetric sensors, reagent-based sensors, microbial sensors, pathogen sensors, and/or other sensors configured to measure or detect various characteristics of a fluid or a solution. Additionally, the nutrient sensors **760** may include temperature sensors, liquid level sensors, liquid flow sensors, pressure sensors, and/or other sensors configured to measure or detect physical attributes of a fluid or a solution.

[0081] The environmental sensors **765** may be configured to measure or detect one or more environmental characteristics or attributes affecting the plant growth system **600**. The environmental sensors **765** may, in some embodiments, be positioned on the plant module **605** (e.g., on the body **620**). However, in other embodiments, the environmental sensors **765** may be positioned in any suitable location on the plant growth system **600**. The environmental sensors **765** may include air temperature sensors, humidity sensors (e.g., hygrometers), air flow sensors (e.g., anemometers), carbon dioxide (CO₂) sensors, volatile organic compound (VOC) sensors, air quality sensors (e.g., particulate matter sensors such as PM_{2.5}, PM₁₀, etc.), ambient light sensors (e.g., lux meters, PAR sensors, etc.), optical spectrometers, UV radiation sensors, and the like.

[0082] The system sensors **770** may be configured to monitor the performance of the plant growth system **600**, for example, by detecting errors, leaks, deteriorating performance, etc. In some embodiments, the system sensors **770** may be configured to initiate indicators or alerts that may be provided to a user to inform the user regarding certain aspects of the performance of the plant growth system **600**. The system sensors **770** may be positioned in any suitable location on the plant growth system **600**.

[0083] In some embodiments, the system sensors **770** may include one or more pump performance sensors configured to monitor the performance of the hydroponic module **610** and, in particular, the pump **690**. For example, the system sensors **770** may include current sensors configured to monitor the electrical current draw of the pump **690**, vibration sensors configured to detect abnormalities in the vibrations emanating from the pump **690**, and/or other sensors configured to monitor the pump **690**. In this way, the system sensors **770** may be configured to detect failures, blockages, wear, and/or other phenomena impacting the operation of the hydroponic module **610**.

[0084] The system sensors **770** may also include leak detection sensors (e.g., configured to detect leaks from the reservoir **680**, containers **700**, and/or other components), power consumption sensors, energy meters, system uptime/downtime monitoring sensors, and the like. Additionally, the system sensors **770** may include safety sensors such as overheat sensors, water level overflow sensors, electrical fault sensors, ground fault circuit interrupters (GFCIs), and the like.

[0085] In some embodiments, the plant growth system **600** may include one or more specialized sensors **775** configured to monitor other aspects of the plant growth system **600**. For example, the specialized sensors **775** may include acoustic sensors configured to monitor sounds produced by plant processes (e.g., cavitation, transpiration, etc.), bioimpedance sensors configured to measure the electrical impedance of plant tissues, electrochemical sensors configured to perform advanced nutrient monitoring for real-time complex nutrient analysis, quantum dot sensors configured to perform multi-analyte detection in nutrient solutions and/or plant tissues, and/or other sensors. In other instances, the specialized sensors **775** may be omitted. Additionally, any of the aforementioned sensors (i.e., sensors **58**, **755**, **760**, **765**, **770**, **775**) may be provided in the form of individual sensors or wireless sensor networks (WSNs).

[0086] The data acquisition node **780** may be in communication with some or all of the aforementioned sensors (i.e., sensors **58**, **755**, **760**, **765**, **770**, **775**) and may be configured to receive information therefrom via wired and/or wireless electronic communication. Thus, the data acquisition node **780** may be configured to store and/or relay the information it receives from the sensor array **745**. For example, the data acquisition node **780** may be in communication with the processor **750**, which may in turn be in communication with one or more other components of the plant growth system **600**.

[0087] The processor **750** may be configured to read, store, process, and/or analyze the information received from the data acquisition node **780** and produce outputs (e.g., information readable by a user) or take action based on that information. As one non-limiting example, the processor **750** may be in communication with the nutrient management module **695** (e.g., with the mixing system **705**), and may be configured to adjust the mixture of nutrients provided by the nutrient management module **695** based on data received from the nutrient sensors **760**. The processor **750** may be in communication with other modules or individual components of the plant growth system **600** and may be configured to adjust their operation based on real-time data in a similar manner.

[0088] Additionally, the processor **750** may be in communication with the actuation module **735** and/or the user interface module **740**. The actuation module **735** may serve as an intermediary between the processor **750** and various operative components of the plant growth system **600**. For example, the actuation module **735** may include a light actuator **785** operatively coupled to the grow light module **615**, a nutrient actuator **790** operatively coupled to the nutrient management module **695**, a fan actuator **795** operatively coupled to the environmental control module **715**, a pump actuator **800** operatively connected to the hydroponic module **610**, and/or other actuators operatively coupled to other components of the plant growth system **600**. In this way, the actuation module **735** may enable the processor **750** to control or adjust the operation of the grow light controller **660**, the mixing valves **710**, the fan unit **725**, the pump **690**, and/or other components of the plant growth system **600** to automatically adjust environmental parameters and system settings to optimize plant growth.

[0089] The user interface module **740** may serve as an intermediary between the processor **750** and

a user, thereby enabling a user to interface with the plant growth system **600** (e.g., monitor performance, adjust various metrics or parameters, alter settings, etc.). For example, the user interface module **740** may include an interface component **805**, a visualization component **810**, and/or additional or alternative parts. The interface component **805** may be configured to enable a user to operate and/or interface with the plant growth system **600**. For example, the user may engage the interface component **805** via dictation, a touch screen, buttons, dials, and/or other suitable mechanisms. In some instances, the interface component **805** may be multi-modal in that it may enable a user to engage the plant growth system **600** via two or more different mechanisms. [0090] The visualization component **810** may be configured to enable a user to read or collect data from the plant growth system **600** (e.g., data collected by the sensor array **745**). For example, the visualization component **810** may be provided in the form of an electronic screen or display configured to depict numerical data, graphs, charts, and/or other visuals or graphics. Both the interface component **805** and the visualization component **810** may be provided in any suitable form. In some embodiments, the interface component **805** and/or the visualization component **810** may be integrally formed with the plant growth system **600**. In other embodiments, the interface component **805** and/or the visualization component **810** may be provided in the form of an external device such as a smartphone or laptop configured for wired or wireless communication with components of the plant growth system **600** such as the sensor module **730**.

[0091] In some embodiments, the hydroponic module **610**, or one or more components thereof (e.g., the fluid delivery system **685**), may be provided in the form of a fluid delivery system **900** as depicted schematically in FIG. **14**, a fluid delivery system **1000** as depicted schematically in FIG. **15**, and/or other forms not specifically described herein.

[0092] As shown in FIG. **14**, the fluid delivery system **900** may include a tank **905** positioned proximate to an upper portion of the plant growth system **600** (e.g., the tank **905** may be positioned proximate to the upper region **65**, as shown in FIG. **4**). However, in other embodiments, the tank may be positioned proximate to a lower portion of the plant growth system **600**, or may be positioned in any suitable location. The tank **905** may be configured to retain a supply of fluid **910** (e.g., water, nutrient solution, other substances, and/or combinations thereof).

[0093] The tank **905** may be in communication with a valve assembly **915** configured to control the distribution of fluid **910**. For example, in some embodiments, the valve assembly **915** may be provided in the form of a solenoid valve manifold including one or more two way valves **920**. In other embodiments, the valve assembly **915** may be provided in any other suitable form. In some embodiments, an inlet **925** may be positioned between the tank **905** and the valve assembly **915**, and the fluid **910** may flow to the valve assembly **915** via the inlet **925**. In some embodiments, the inlet **925** may be a semi-automatic inlet (e.g., operation of the inlet **925** may be at least partially automated) and may include a filtering component.

[0094] The valve assembly **915** may be configured to direct fluid **910** to a drip system **930** of the fluid delivery system **900**. For example, the drip system **930** may be configured to distribute the fluid **910** to the plants (e.g., plants **640**) via gravity. However, in other embodiments, the drip system **930** may be omitted and other fluid delivery mechanisms may be provided, as discussed above. In the example of FIG. **14**, the fluid delivery system **900** may include a settling tank **935** positioned proximate to a lower portion of the plant growth system **600** and configured to collect run-off or fluid **910** distributed by the drip system **930** but not received or collected by the plants **640**.

[0095] In some instances, the fluid delivery system **900** may include a pump **940** (e.g., the pump **940** may be the pump **690** of FIG. **13**) configured to direct the fluid **910** back to the tank **905**. Additionally, the fluid delivery system **900** may include an empty port **945** (e.g., configured to enable the removal of fluid **910** from the fluid delivery system **900**).

[0096] Turning to FIG. **15**, the fluid delivery system **1000** may be substantially similar to the fluid delivery system **900**. For example, the fluid delivery system **1000** may also include a tank **1005**

positioned proximate to an upper portion of the plant growth system **600** and configured to retain a supply of fluid **1010**. In other embodiments, the tank **1005** may be positioned proximate to a lower portion of the plant growth system **600**.

[0097] The tank **1005** may be in communication with a valve assembly **1015** configured to control the distribution of the fluid **1010**. The valve assembly **1015** may be substantially similar to the valve assembly **915** and may include one or more two way valves **1020**. The fluid delivery system **1000** may include an inlet **1025** provided in substantially the same form as the inlet **925**.

Additionally, the fluid delivery system **1000** may include a pump **1040** (e.g., the pump **1040** may be the pump **690** of FIG. **13**) configured to direct the fluid **1010** back to the tank **1005**.

Additionally, the fluid delivery system **1000** may include an empty port **1045** (e.g., configured to enable the removal of fluid **1010** from the fluid delivery system **1000**).

[0098] The fluid delivery system **1000** may include one or more gutters **1030** configured to direct the fluid **1010** to the plants **640**. For example, the gutters **1030** may be positioned at various heights with respect to the body **620** (e.g., the gutters **1030** may be arranged to align with the plant holders **630**). In some embodiments, each gutter **1030** may include a filter or inlet **1025**. The two way valves **1020** of the valve assembly **1015** may be configured to open and close independently from one another such that fluid **1010** may be directed to one or more gutters **1030** but not others. In the example of FIG. **15**, the fluid delivery system **1000** may include eight two way valves **1020**.

However, in other embodiments, the fluid delivery system **1000** may include any suitable number of two way valves **1020**.

[0099] While the fluid delivery systems **900**, **1000** represent exemplary fluid delivery systems that can be provided with the hydroponic module **610** to distribute fluid to the plants **640**, other fluid delivery systems are envisioned and may include additional and/or alternative components as compared to the fluid delivery systems **900**, **1000**.

[0100] In some further embodiments, a wall hanging (not illustrated) may be provided with additional features to help facilitate growing the plants **15**. For example, alternative embodiments of a wall hanging may include a bubbler (not illustrated) and/or an aerator (not illustrated). The bubbler and/or the aerator may draw air from the ambient environment, and the bubbler and/or the aerator may pump the air into the fluid **55** (e.g., via tubing and/or an air stone). Thus, the bubbler and/or the aerator may help to keep the fluid **55** fresh. In addition, alternative embodiments of a wall hanging may include one or more fans (not illustrated) to help facilitate growing the plants **15**. The one or more fans may be positioned and located on or adjacent to a grow light assembly (e.g., the grow light assemblies **130**, **230**, **315**, **415**, **515** illustrated FIGS. **8-12**). Further, the one or more fans may be oriented such that an axis of rotation is directed toward or away from the one or more plants **15**. Thus, the one or more fans may push or pull air past the foliage of the plants **15** to increase transpiration rates and to facilitate growing the plants **15**.

[0101] From the foregoing, it will be seen that the various embodiments of the present invention are well adapted to attain all the objectives and advantages hereinabove set forth together with still other advantages which are obvious, and which are inherent to the present structures. It will be understood that certain features and sub-combinations of the present embodiments are of utility and may be employed without reference to other features and sub-combinations. Since many possible embodiments of the present invention may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention, it is also to be understood that all disclosures herein set forth or illustrated in the accompanying drawings are to be interpreted as illustrative only and not limiting. The various constructions described above and illustrated in the drawings are presented by way of example only and are not intended to limit the concepts, principles, and scope of the present invention.

[0102] Many changes, modifications, variations, and other uses and applications of the present invention will, however, become apparent to those skilled in the art after considering the specification and the accompanying drawings. All such changes, modifications, variations, and

other uses and applications which do not depart from the spirit and scope of the invention are deemed to be covered by the invention, which is limited only by the claims which follow.

Claims

1. A plant growth system comprising: a body for supporting one or more plants; a cover including one or more through-holes, each plant configured to extend at least partially through one of the through-holes; and a grow light coupled to the body, the grow light movable between a first position and a second position.
2. The plant growth system of claim 1, further comprising a sensor module, an actuation module in communication with the sensor module, and a user interface module in communication with the sensor module.
3. The plant growth system of claim 2, further comprising an array system positioned proximate to the cover, the array system including one or more interchangeable plant holders configured to receive the one or more plants.
4. The plant growth system of claim 3, wherein each of the one or more plant holders includes a channel and a spout configured to direct fluid toward one of the one or more plants.
5. The plant growth system of claim 3, wherein each of the one or more plant holders includes at least one permeable portion configured to allow fluid to flow into and out of the plant holder and at least one drip feature.
6. The plant growth system of claim 1, wherein the cover is interchangeable.
7. The plant growth system of claim 1, wherein the grow light includes a first arm and a second arm, wherein the first arm and the second arm are positioned adjacent to the cover when the grow light is in the first position, and wherein the first arm and the second arm each extend outwardly away from the cover such that the grow light is configured to emit light toward the cover when the grow light is in the second position.
8. A plant growth system comprising: an interchangeable frame; a plurality of plant holders coupled to the frame, the plurality of plant holders retaining a plurality of plants; a cover including a plurality of through-holes, the plurality of plants each extending at least partially through one of the through-holes; and a grow light configured to emit light toward the cover.
9. The plant growth system of claim 8, wherein the grow light is coupled to the frame via a mount, the mount configured to retain the grow light at a distance from the frame.
10. The plant growth system of claim 8, further comprising an array system including a plurality of array units, each array unit receiving one of the plant holders.
11. The plant growth system of claim 10, wherein each of the plurality of plant holders includes a flange and each of the plurality of array units includes a lip, and wherein the flange of the plant holder is configured to engage the lip of the associated array unit when the plant holder is received by the array unit.
12. The plant growth system of claim 8 further comprising a reservoir positioned proximate to a lower portion of the frame and retaining a supply of fluid and a pump in communication with the reservoir and configured to direct the fluid from the reservoir to the plurality of plants.
13. The plant growth system of claim 8, wherein the grow light is movable between a first position in which the grow light is positioned adjacent to the frame and a second position in which the grow light is retained at a distance from the frame and configured to emit light toward the cover.
14. The plant growth system of claim 13, wherein the grow light includes a linkage arm mechanism configured to facilitate movement of the grow light between the first position and the second position.
15. A plant growth system comprising: a body supporting one or more plants, the one or more plants being received by one or more plant holders coupled to the body; a grow light movable between a first position and a second position and configured to emit light toward the one or more

plants; and a fluid delivery system configured to direct fluid toward the one or more plant holders.

16. The plant growth system of claim 15, wherein the fluid delivery system comprises a tank retaining the fluid, a valve assembly in communication with the tank, and at least one gutter in communication with the valve assembly and configured to direct the fluid to the one or more plants.

17. The plant growth system of claim 15, wherein each of the one or more plant holders includes a channel, a spout, and at least one permeable portion positioned proximate to the spout, the permeable portion configured to allow fluid to enter and exit the plant holder.

18. The plant growth system of claim 15, wherein the fluid delivery system comprises a reservoir positioned below the array system and configured to retain the fluid and a pump in communication with the reservoir and configured to move the fluid from the reservoir to an upper portion of the array system.

19. The plant growth system of claim 15, further comprising an interchangeable cover configured to be detachably coupled to the body, wherein the cover includes one or more through holes, and wherein the one or more plants are arranged to extend at least partially through the through-holes of the cover.

20. The plant growth system of claim 19, wherein the cover is configured to reduce light exposure and/or retain humidity such that the plant growth system provides an in-situ germination system.
